Yet many, in the Third World and the First, argue that environmental consciousness is a luxury, and that economic development necessary for the survival of the world's poor must come first. "It is particularly rare for governments anywhere to propose, adopt, or enforce stricter environmental requirements during times of economic crisis," Daniel Whittle and Orlando Rey Santos point out.[29]

Nevertheless, Cuba's 1992 Constitutional amendments incorporated new environmental concerns. Chapter 1, Article 27, regarding "the state, the environment, and natural resources" recognizes "the close links they have with sustainable economic and social development to make human life more rational and to ensure the survival, well-being and security of present and future generations" and mandates that "it is the duty of citizens to contribute to the protection of the waters, atmosphere, the conservation of the soil, flora, fauna and nature's entire rich potential." The new Constitution was followed by a formal adoption of the 1992 Rio Summit principles on the environment, the establishment of a Ministry of Science, Technology and the Environment in 1994, and the passage of a plethora of laws to implement new forms of new environmental protection.

On paper, Cuba's new environmental legislation is impressive. The challenges, as Whittle and Rey Santos point out, lie in the competing interests of economic development and environmental protection, and in the fact that given the state's role in the Cuban economy, the government is essentially regulating itself.[30] Yet Whittle and Rey Santos, as well as other analysts, see encouraging signs that the will to enforce the laws is solid.[31]

Contradictions: Inequality and *Jineterismo*

There were a number of ways in which the economic openings, while ostensibly racially neutral, in fact tended to the advantage of lighter-skinned Cubans. Despite the relative socioeconomic equality that the